

Making Inferences, Paraphrasing and Summarizing

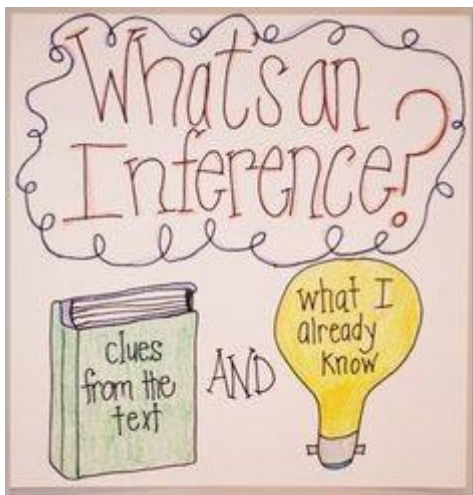
Objective:

General: Students are able to infer missing information from reading passage and then they are also able to paraphrase and summarize the text in the appropriate ways.

Specific: At the end of this chapter students are able to:

1. Write an inference based on the information
2. Rewrite sentences using student own words
3. Summarize the text in appropriate ways

A. MAKING INFERENCES



This anchor chart is a visual for students to use when they are thinking about making inferences. Readers can use clues from the text and what they already know to help make inferences.

This strategy deepens student connection with the text. Inference is drawing conclusions based on information that has been implied rather than directly stated and is an essential skill in

reading comprehension. We make inferences every day, both in oral and written communication. Many times this is so automatic; we don't even realize the information wasn't included in the conversation or text.

For example, read the following sentences:

My friend and I tried to pack light but we made sure not to forget our bathing suits and sunscreen. I wasn't sure if I would get seasick again so I made sure to pack some medicine for upset stomachs.

You can deduct a great deal of information from these sentences:

- The author and his/her friend are going on a trip.
- They are going to be on a boat.
- They will be around water.
- They will be going swimming.
- They have gone swimming before.
- The author has gotten seasick on a boat in the past.

This information was not clearly stated in the sentences, but you can use what was written to deduce or infer, much more than what was said. Most of the information we get from reading comes from what is implied rather than direct statements.

Making inferences is a reading strategy where "readers think about and search the text, and sometimes use personal knowledge to construct meaning beyond what is literally stated" (Into the Book, 2015). In other words, students use clues found in the text to determine what the information really means. Observations happen when people physically see things happen. On the contrary, "inferences are what we figure out based on an experience" (Reading Rockets, 2015). It's important to remember that making inferences is a skill that is developed over time and requires student to make connections to multiple pieces of information.

Making inferences requires students to combine what they are reading with what they already know, to reach into their own personal knowledge and apply it to what they are reading.

TASK 1

Circle the letter of the inference you can make based on the information.

1. The young woman in the coffee shop kept checking the time on her watch and looking toward the door.
 - a. she was afraid that her watch was broken
 - b. she was waiting for her coffee to cool
 - c. she was waiting for someone to arrive

2. Harry was sneezing and coughing a lot in class. His face was very pale.
a. Harry was sick
b. Harry was trying to disturb the class
c. Harry was tired because he always stays up too late.
3. Outside the bank, a man in a blue shirt was gesturing with his arms and smiling as he spoke. Then he and the two men started to laugh.
a. the man in the blue shirt was doing arm exercises
b. the man in the blue shirt was trying to hit the other men
c. the man in the blue shirt was telling a funny story
4. When we went to visit Liz at her apartment last week, we noticed that she had maps on the walls. Plane tickets to Japan on her table, and art objects from all over the world on her bookshelves.
a. Liz is an artist
b. Liz is a travel agent
c. Liz enjoys travelling to different countries
5. A woman has been standing in front of her house for ten minutes. She is looking in her pockets. She is emptying her purse. She seems annoyed.
a. The woman can't find her keys
b. the woman doesn't like her purse
c. the woman has too many pockets

TASK 2

Work with a partner. Write an inference based on the information.

1. Jorge put a plate of French fries with ketchup on the table and then went to buy a drink. When he returned, most of the French fries were gone, and Jorge noticed that his friend Carlos had ketchup on his mouth.
Carlos was the one who ate Jorge's Fries.

2. During the test, Rose waited until the teacher was answering a student's question. Then she quickly passed a small piece of paper to Jenny.

Rose and Jenny were cheating on the test.

3. A reporter asked a politician how the government was going to provide social services if he cuts taxes. The politician made a joke but didn't answer the question.

The politician avoided answering the question.

4. The door to the apartment flew open. A man raced out and ran over to the elevator. He waited for just a few seconds and then ran down the stairs.

The man was in a hurry or running late

5. In the opening scene of the movie, there were women wearing long dresses. There were horses on the road but no cars.

The movie is set in the past, possibly in the early 1900s or late 1800s

TASK 3

Preview the passage. Then read it and underline the facts. Working with another student and answer the questions that follow.

Olive oil works as a Natural Painkiller

It is not just price that makes extra virgin olive oils different from other oils. Now scientists have discovered that it contains a chemical compound that acts similarly to the painkiller ibuprofen.

Paul Breslin from the Monell Chemical Senses Center in Philadelphia and colleagues describe in *Nature* how they isolated a compound called oleocanthal from extra virgin olive oil. Pouring 50 gm of the best olive oil on your food each day is equivalent to about 10 percent of the average ibuprofen dose.

1. What facts are included in the first paragraph?

- **Extra virgin olive oil is different from other oils not only because of the price.**
- **Scientists have discovered that it contains a chemical compound similar to ibuprofen.**

2. What can you infer about the price of extra virgin olive oil?

Extra virgin olive oil is more expensive than other kinds of oil.

3. What can you infer about other kinds of oils?

Other oils do not contain the same natural pain-relieving compound found in extra virgin olive oil.

4. What facts are included in the second paragraph?

- **Paul Breslin is from the Monell Chemical Senses Center in Philadelphia.**
- **He and his colleagues isolated a compound called oleocanthal from extra virgin olive oil.**
- **Pouring 50 grams of high-quality olive oil on food each day is equal to about 10% of the average ibuprofen dose.**

5. What inferences can you make about Paul Breslin?

- **He is a scientist/researcher.**
- **He studies chemical compounds related to taste and health.**
- **He likely works in the field of chemical senses, since he researches compounds found in foods.**

A New Pesticide in India

In two states in India, Andhra Pradesh and Chatisgarh, farmers have discovered a new kind of pesticide. Instead of paying large sums of money to international chemical companies for chemical pesticides, they are spraying their cotton and chilli pepper fields with coca cola.

In the past month there have been reports of hundreds of farmers spraying cola on their fields. Thousands of others are expected to make the switch to cola from the usual pesticides as word spreads about the new spray. A farmer in Andhra Pradesh interviewed by a local newspaper said he was very satisfied with his new cola spray, which he applied this year to several acres of cotton. He observed that the insects on his cotton plants began to die soon after he sprayed his field with cola.

Local agriculture officials would not comment on this new development, except to note that the cola spray cost considerably less than the pesticides produced by Monstsanto, Shell and Dow chemical. The Coca Cola Company already is in legal difficulties in Andhra Pradesh state, where it has been accused of taking water away from farmers for its bottling plants. So far, representatives of the Coca Cola Company have refused to comment on the new use of their product. It is not known if or how sales of the soft drinks have been affected, tough it is likely that the company may try to profit from this new market.

1. What facts are included in the first paragraph?
 - **Farmers in Andhra Pradesh and Chhattisgarh discovered a new type of pesticide.**
 - **Instead of using a lot of money to buy expensive chemical pesticides, they are spraying their fields with Coca-Cola.**
 - **They are using it on cotton and chili pepper fields.**
2. What can you infer about the cost of pesticides in India?
Chemical pesticides are very expensive, especially for small farmers.
3. What facts are included in the second paragraph?
 - **Hundreds of farmers have already sprayed cola on their fields in the past month.**
 - **Thousands more are expected to switch to cola.**
 - **A farmer in Andhra Pradesh said he was satisfied with the cola spray because insects died soon after spraying cola.**
 - **He used it on several acres of cotton.**
4. What can you infer about the cola spray?
 - **The cola spray seems effective at killing insects**
 - **It seems to be effective enough that trust it enough to try it on large plots.**
 - **It is likely cheaper and easier to obtain than chemical pesticides.**
5. What facts are included in the third paragraph?
 - **Local agriculture officials did not comment on the development.**
 - **They noted that cola spray is much cheaper than pesticides made by companies like Monsanto, Shell, and Dow Chemical.**
 - **Coca-Cola is already in legal trouble in Andhra Pradesh for allegedly taking water from farmers.**
 - **Coca-Cola representatives have refused to comment on the new use of cola.**
 - **It is unknown how the sales are affected.**
 - **The company may try to profit from this new situation.**
6. What can you infer about the economic situation of the farmers in Andhra Pradesh?
 - **Farmers are struggling financially so they look for cheaper alternatives like cola instead of expensive pesticides.**

7. What can you infer about the Coca Cola Company in India?

- **The company is facing criticism and legal issues from farmers.**
- **They may see a business opportunity to make additional profit from farmers using cola as pesticide.**
- **They are being cautious about responding, possibly to protect their public image.**

Task 4: Reading text

Swimming Buddies

Making Friends

Five years ago, a fisherman named Abeidalla Mekiten spotted a big, gray animal swimming near his fishing boat. It was a bottlenose dolphin.

Over the next few days, Mekiten, who lives in Nuweiba, Egypt, watched the dolphin patiently. He decided to dive into the water for a closer look. To Mekiten's surprise the dolphin didn't swim away. Instead she looked at him cautiously. Day after day the two swam together. Mekiten named the dolphin Olin. Then one morning, Olin let the fisherman touch her. A long friendship began between the wild, free dolphin and the young man.

Social Animals

Dolphins do not like to be alone. They are social animals that like to live with others. Most dolphins live in family groups of up to twelve members. The groups are called pods. Often, many pods swim together to form larger groups of hundreds of dolphins. Occasionally one dolphin is forced out of its pod by other dolphins in the pod. "Those that are thrown out may not want to be alone," says Oz Goffman, a marine biologist (a scientist who studies animals that live in the water) at the University of Haifa. He studies the friendship between Mekiten and Olin. A single dolphin may be lonely. It might "replace the companionship of the pod with that of human beings". Such behavior may explain why Olin, completely free to swim away, has stayed near Nuweiba. Once in while, Olin joins a passing dolphin pod for a few days, but she always returns to the waters off Nuweiba.

A baby is born

During a visit with other dolphins, Olin became pregnant. A year later she gave birth to a male calf. Now Mekiten plays with mother and

baby. Says Goffman, "Human-dolphin friendships are rare, but this is obviously a friendship Olin wants, or she would leave." So far Olin seems content to stay.

Tourists from all over the world now visit Nuweiba for a chance to swim alongside the wild dolphin. They must be careful not to get too close, because Olin is not always as friendly with strangers as she is with Mekiten.

As you read the article, complete the chart on the opposite page with details from the article.

Details
Gave birth to a male calf Became friends with a wild dolphin Live in family groups called pods Studies the friendship between Mekiten and Olin Became pregnant A fisherman from Nuweiba, Egypt Is not always friendly to strangers Social animals A marine biologist Always returns to the waters off Nuweiba

Topic	Details
Abeidalla Mekiten	1. Became friends with a wild dolphin 2. A fisherman from Nuweiba, Egypt
Olin	1. Became pregnant 2. Gave birth to a male calf 3. Is not always friendly to strangers 4. Always returns to the waters off Nuweiba
Dr. Oz Goffman	1. A marine biologist 2. Studies the friendship between Mekiten and Olin
Bottlenose dolphins	1. Social animals 2. Live in family groups called pods

After you have read ‘swimming buddies’, complete the following exercises.

A. Write T(True) or F (False) next to each of the following statements. If statement is false, correct it to make it true.

- T 1. Mekiten and Olin are friends.
- T 2. Tourists come to Nuweiba to swim with Olin.
- T 3. Most dolphins live in family groups called pods.
- T 4. Sometimes hundreds of dolphins swim together.
- T 5. Olin gave birth to a male calf.
- F 6. Oz Goffman is a fisherman.
- T 7. dolphins are social animal.
- F 8. Dolphins are often forced out of their pods.
- T 9. Human-dolphin friendships are rare.
- F 10. Only scientists visit Nuweiba for a chance to swim with Olin.

B. Make Inferences. . put a check next to the statements that you can infer from reading “Swimming Buddies.”

- v 1. Mekiten is a good swimmer
- v 2. Olin likes Mekiten
- 3. Dolphins rarely have twins.
- 4. Sometimes Olin is friendly to strangers.
- 5. Nuweiba is the only place tourists can go to swim with dolphins,
- 6. Pops of dolphins swim together for protection.
- v 7. Olin prefers to be in the waters off Nuweiba.
- 8. The university of Haifa has a famous marine biology department.
- v 9. When Mekiten first saw Olin, he expected the dolphin to swim away.
- v 10. Most dolphins live in the wild.

C. Each of the following words from the article has more than one meaning. Use a dictionary to find the definition that fits the word as it is used in the sentence. Write the definition on the line.

- 1. Such behavior may explain why Olin, completely free to swim away, has stayed near Nuweiba.

Free: enjoying personal freedom; not subject to the control or domination of another

2. Tourists from all over the world now visit Nuweiba for a chance to swim alongside the wild dolphins.

Chance: **a situation favoring some purpose; opportunity**

3. Five years ago, a fisherman named Abeidalla Mekiten spotted a big, gray animal swimming near his fishing boat.

Spotted: **detect; notice**

4. Once in a while, Olin joins a passing dolphin pod for a few days, but she always returns to the waters off Nuweiba.

Passing: **going by or past**

5. "Human-dolphin friendships are rare, but this is obviously a friendship Olin wants, or she would leave."

Rare: **seldom occurring or found; uncommon**

B. PARAPHRASING AND SUMMARIZING

The terms *paraphrasing* and *summarizing* often confuse students of English. This is not surprising since the two mean very similar things with just a slight difference. First off, what are paraphrasing and summarizing?

Paraphrasing and summarizing are both indispensable writing tools. They are both techniques of incorporating other writers' works or ideas into your writing using your own words. Although a writer must always use his/her own ideas when writing, sometimes it becomes necessary to use other writers' thoughts and concepts.

This may be due to one or more of the following reasons:

1. To provide support to your own ideas
2. To give reasons of why you agree or disagree with something
3. To give depth to your writing
4. To refer to something that led to your ideas
5. To give a point of view which is different from yours.

These some reasons for paraphrasing and summarizing are the cause of the confusion between the two. So what is the difference then?

Paraphrasing is re-writing another writer's words or ideas in your own words without altering the meaning. The paraphrase is about the same length as the original since the purpose is to rephrase without leaving out anything, and not to shorten.

Summarizing, on the other hand, is putting down the main ideas of someone else's work in your own words. A summary is always shorter than the original since the idea is to include only the main points of the original work and to leave out the irrelevant. A summary is usually about one-third the size of the original.

Now when should you paraphrase and when should you summarize?

Paraphrase when:

- You want to use another writer's words without plagiarizing
- You want to use another writer's words without the use of quotes
- The ideas of the other writer are more important than his/her style
- You think that the words of the other writer are too difficult for your readers.

Summarize when:

- You want to identify only the main ideas of the writer

- You want to give an overview of the topic (from several sources)
- You want to simplify a complex argument
- You want to condense the matter to suit your requirement

Tips for paraphrasing

Do:

- use your own words, synonyms or synonym phrases.
- change the order of the information, change the grammar and sentence structure.
- keep the meaning, as well as the emphasis on and relationships between main and supporting points the same.
- reference the original text when paraphrasing written material.

Don't:

- repeat the information word for word, or change a word here and there, leaving most of the text and the sentence order the same.
- add your own opinions or thoughts - the information should be the same as in the original source.

Summarizing tips

Do:

- use your own words.
- only note the most important points, using key words and phrases.
- read the original text multiple times, ensuring you don't miss any critical points.
- ensure a summary is much shorter than the original source.
- include the original source in the references for a written document.
- read widely and try to develop a summary of the article/book in your head as you read.

Don't:

- include unnecessary details, examples or supporting information.
- include your own opinions or thoughts.
- repeat phrases word for word - this is plagiarism.

How do you take notes?

- Lists of keywords and information

- Mind-maps or trees
- Writing your own summary
- All of the above!

Task 1. Find the correct English word for the given phrase.

Example:

1. the time between the lessons → break
2. A list which shows when lessons begin and end. → **schedule**
3. A large thing where the teacher writes on with a piece of chalk. → **blackboard**
4. The material that you write and draw on. → **paper**
5. A small bag for your pens. → **pencil case**
6. A special word for a child in a school. → **student**
7. The room where the children and a teacher are. → **classroom**
8. The person who looks after the school. → **caretaker**
9. A formal written, spoken or practical test. → **exam**
10. The people who work at a school. → **staff/teachers**

Task 2.

This exercise requires you to rewrite a series of sentences using your own words (paraphrase the text).

1. Working from home can lead to employees feeling isolated and dissatisfied.

Remote work can make employees feel cut off from others and unhappy with their jobs.

2. The increase in the number of students attending university has led to changes in the methods and style of lecture delivery.

More students enrolling in universities has forced the lecturers to change their method of teaching and presenting information.

3. Academic writing plays a very important role in university education as it is the medium in which students demonstrate their understanding of the subject.

Academic writing is crucial in higher education because it allows students to prove how well they understand the material.

4. Courses should contain a practical component ensuring graduates have skills that are transferable to the work place

Including practical work in courses helps ensure graduates have abilities suited for the workplace.

5. The introduction of certain austerity measures has greatly reduced the amount of disposable income for most middle income homes.

Many middle-class families now have much less money available to spend because of new cost-cutting policies.

6. Mass tourism in developing countries needs to be addressed to allow for a more sustainable approach.

Large-scale tourism in developing nations must be managed to ensure long-term, sustainable development.

Task 3

Read each paragraph and mark the text to show the main idea and the supporting facts and ideas. Then fill in the questions below.

Wetland

Wetlands are areas of land that are covered by water all or part of the year. Throughout history, people have considered wetlands to be land that was wasted and could be put to better use. For this reason, from the time of the Romans, wetlands have been drained and filled so that the land could be used for human activity. Wetlands have been converted into farmland, city neighborhoods, industrial facilities, or garbage dumps. However, in recent years, scientists, environmentalists, and even politicians have begun to realize that wetlands are a valuable part of the environment, as well as a valuable resource for humans.

Main idea:

People used to view wetlands as useless land to be developed. However, today many people recognize that wetlands are important and beneficial to the environment and humans.

Pattern of organization:

Comparison/contrast

Supporting facts and ideas:

- **Wetlands are areas that remain underwater for part or all of the year.**
- **For centuries, people believed wetlands were wasted land.**
- **Since Roman times, wetlands have been drained and filled for human use.**
- **Many wetlands were turned into farmland, neighbourhoods, factories, or dumps.**
- **Recently, experts and leaders have begun to recognize the importance of wetlands.**

Summary sentence:

Although wetlands were long treated as useless land, they are now acknowledged as essential for sustaining the environment.